



Accelerating County Adoption and Implementation of the National School Re-entry Guides 2020

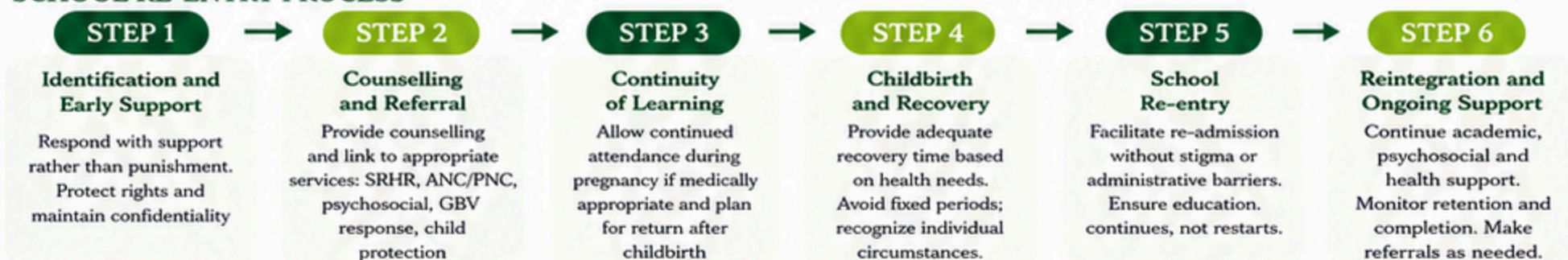
For many girls, pregnancy and child marriage marks the beginning of permanent school dropout. Without deliberate support to return to school, adolescent mothers are more likely to experience repeat pregnancies, economic hardship, early marriage, gender-based violence, poor health outcomes and lifelong social exclusion

The National School Re-entry Guidelines (2020) provide a framework for ensuring that pregnancy does not end a learner's education. Full county adoption and implementation of the Guidelines safeguards the right to education while advancing adolescent sexual and reproductive health and rights, gender equality and inclusive development

What the Guidelines Require

- 1 Protect Every Learner's Right to Education:** Every learner has the constitutional right to continue learning without discrimination. Pregnancy or parenthood should never be grounds for exclusion from education
- 2 Support Continuity of Learning:** Schools should support pregnant learners to remain in school for as long as medically appropriate and facilitate their return after childbirth through flexible and learner-centred approaches
- 3 Ensure Safe and Dignified School Re-entry:** Learners returning to school should be treated with dignity, respect and confidentiality, free from stigma, discrimination and punitive practices
- 4 Provide Integrated Support Services:** Schools should collaborate with health facilities, child protection services, social protection programmes and community structures to ensure learners receive appropriate SRHR information and services, counselling, psychosocial support and GBV response services.
- 5 Promote Shared Responsibility:** Successful implementation requires coordinated action between the education, health, gender and child protection sectors, alongside parents, communities, religious leaders, civil society organizations and development partners

SCHOOL RE-ENTRY PROCESS



Investing in girls' education today builds healthier families, stronger communities and a more equitable future.
Every learner. Every opportunity. Every time.

HOMA BAY COUNTY AT A GLANCE

Teenage pregnancy: **23.2%**
(National: 14.8%)

Girls completing primary school: **54%**

Girls transitioning to secondary school: **52%**

Young people (15-24) living with HIV: **>6%**, more than three times the national average

County Implementation Scorecard

COUNTY IMPLEMENTATION SCORECARD

CRITICAL AREA	CURRENT STATUS	PRIORITY ACTION
County implementation framework	Mature	Develop county SOPs
Budget allocation	Limited	Allocate dedicated funding
Teacher capacity	Inadequate	Train teachers and school heads
School–health referral system	Weak	Formalize referral pathways
Community awareness	Low	Conduct county-wide sensitization
Monitoring	Weak	Track school re-entry and completion

WHO NEEDS TO ACT

County Assembly

Champion the domestication of the National School Re-entry Guidelines into county policies and plans. Provide oversight and ensure adequate budget allocation to support school re-entry programmes across the county.

Department of Education

Lead the implementation of the School Re-entry Guidelines by developing county implementation frameworks, training school heads and teachers, and ensuring safe and supportive environments for learners returning after pregnancy.

Department of Health

Ensure that pregnant learners and adolescent mothers have access to adolescent-friendly health services, including antenatal and postnatal care, family planning, counselling and mental health support.

Department of Gender and Social Protection

Strengthen prevention and response to gender-based violence while ensuring that learners affected by violence receive appropriate protection, counselling and psychosocial support

County Treasury

Allocate adequate resources to support the implementation of the School Re-entry Guidelines. This includes funding for teacher training, community sensitization, monitoring, and coordinated programmes across the education, health and gender sectors.

WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE



Increased school re-entry among adolescent mothers



Reduced repeat adolescent pregnancies



Reduced school dropout



Increased completion rates



Improved access to adolescent-friendly SRHR services



Stronger coordination between Education, Health and Gender sectors